Annotation Guideline

Introduction

This guideline aims to provide the background and instruction on annotating the Malaysian parliament Hansard.

Our studies **focus on the interaction between MPs (members of parliament) that happens in Malaysia parliamentary sessions**, in the form of Hansard.

The **Hansard can be viewed as a multi-party conversation (MPC)**, where there are more than two participants in a conversation, and forms a complex network of interaction.

In our study, we are interested in two particular aspects: (1) **the addressee(s) of the utterances**, and (2) **the discourse relations between utterances**.

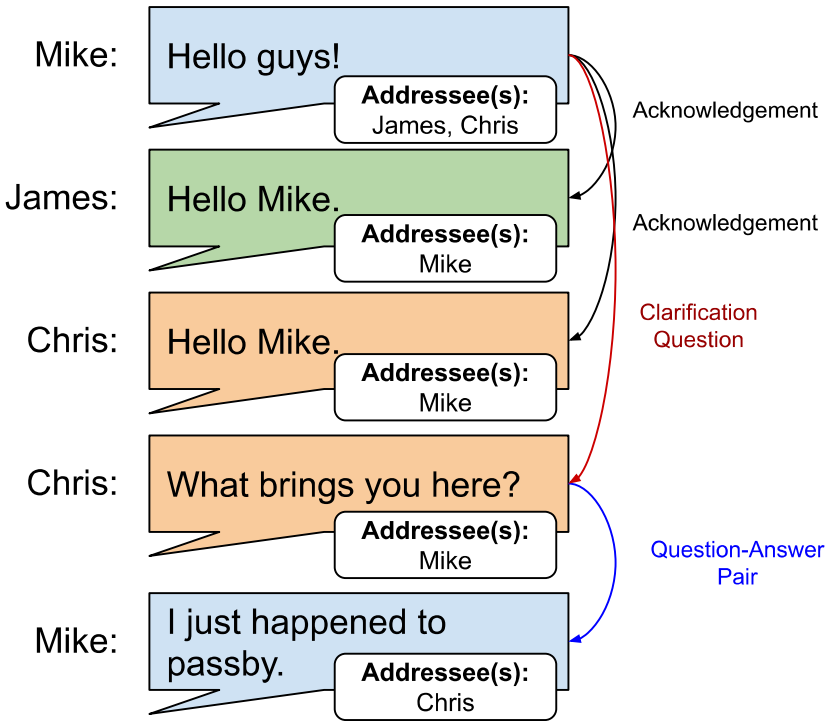


Figure 1:
A sample multi-party conversation annotated with addressee(s) and discourse relations.

Utterance vs EDU

In reality, we are not labeling the data at the utterance level. Instead, we segment them into chunks, as what we called EDUs.

What is an Utterance?

An utterance is the collection of words spoken in one turn, it can be one or more sentences.

What is an EDU?

EDU is the abbreviation for **elementary discourse unit** is, which is a **segment of text** that acts as the basic unit of discourse structure. The EDUs are already segmented for each sentence of each utterance.

How is EDU segmented?

We first break down utterances into sentences, and then further break it down into EDUs using a segmentation model.

Utterance > ***Sentence*** > ***EDU***

Here's an example:

Utterance
Puan Young Syefura binti Othman [Bentong]: [Assalamualaikum warahmatullahi wabarakatuh and greetings. Thank you for giving Bentong the opportunity to discuss this evening.]$_{utterance}$
Sentences
Puan Young Syefura binti Othman [Bentong]: [Assalamualaikum warahmatullahi wabarakatuh and greetings.]$_{sentence}$ [Thank you for giving Bentong the opportunity to discuss this evening.]$_{sentence}$
EDUs
Puan Young Syefura binti Othman [Bentong]: [Assalamualaikum warahmatullahi wabarakatuh and greetings.]$_{edu}$ [Thank you for giving Bentong the opportunity]$_{edu}$ [to discuss this evening.]$_{edu}$

Addressee

The addressee are the intended recipient of the message. We want to know whether each EDU is addressed to who.

Rules

1. An EDU can **have one or more addressees**, as seen in Figure 1.
2. Sometimes, if an EDU is addressed to all the participants in the conversation, we can annotate the addressee as **“everyone”**.
3. If you think the EDU addresses no one in particular, choose **“everyone”**.
4. **DO NOT** tick **“everyone”** and then also tick some particular addressee(s), it will be assumed to address everyone.

Rhetorical Relation

Rhetorical relations are the **functional or structural relations between two spans of texts**. In our work, we adopted the STAC’s style SDRT framework, which contains 16 types of discourse relations.

Please check Table 1 for the detailed definition of each rhetorical relation type.

Rules

1. Arrow should always point downwards.
2. It can be many-to-many relations, each

Relation	**Definition**	**Example**
1. Acknowledgement	Acknowledgement can be: 1. signals an understanding of what was said 2. an acceptance of what was said 3. an acceptance and a signal to change the topic of conversation or move on <u>Important Cues:</u> ● **'OK'** ● **'Right'** ● **'Right then'** ● **'Good'** ● **'Fine'** ● **'Thank you'**	**Tuan Yang di-Pertua:** I invite Mr. Lim Guan Eng, Bagan. *Saya jemput Tuan Lim Guan Eng, Bagan.* **Tuan Lim Guan Eng [Bagan]:** Thank you Mr. Speaker but before I… *Terima kasih Tuan Yang di-Pertua tetapi sebelum saya.*
2. Alternation	Logical operation: Or, where it marks the presence of a disjunction between A and B. <u>Important Cues:</u> **1. 'or'**	**Datuk Seri Dr. Ronald Kiandee [Beluran]:** A question can not contain any arguments, assumptions, thoughts, accusations, praises *Sesuatu pertanyaan itu tidak boleh mengandungi apa-apa hujah, sangkaan, fikiran, tohmah, puji atau keji atau mengandungi kalimah-kalimah mengelirukan, menyindir* **Datuk Seri Dr. Ronald Kiandee [Beluran]:** or despicable words or contain confounding, sarcastic or hurtful words or about any superficial matter *atau menyakitkan hati ataupun mengenai apa-apa perkara dangkal atau meminta penerangan mengenai perkara-perkara remeh.*
3. Background	When B provides some stage setting (context) for the event	**Datuk Seri Dr. Ronald Kiandee [Beluran]:** A

	that happens in A. Sometimes we have Background(B , A) where the background comes first Important Cue: 1. **`While…`**	question can not contain any arguments, assumptions, thoughts, accusations, praises *Sesuatu pertanyaan itu tidak boleh mengandungi apa-apa hujah, sangkaan, fikiran, tohmah, puji atau keji atau mengandungi kalimah-kalimah mengelirukan, menyindir* **Datuk Seri Dr. Ronald Kiandee [Beluran]:** That's the entire context of Meeting Rule 23(1)(c). *Itu keseluruhan konteks Peraturan Mesyuarat 23(1)(c).*
4. Clarification_question	B is a question to clarify about A, can be on domain level or concerning what was said. Important Cue: 2. **Question mark (?)**	**Tuan Lim Guan Eng [Bagan]:** All these Members of Parliament from Penang, don't be traitors to your own state. *Semua ini Ahli Parlimen dari Pulau Pinang ini, jangan jadi pengkhianat kepada negeri sendiri.* **Tuan Muhammad Fawwaz bin Mohamad Jan [Permatang Pauh]:** What about it? *Apa pula?*
5. Contrast	A and B have similar semantic structures, but contrasting themes, i.e. sentence topics, or when one constituent negates a default consequence of the other. Important Cues: 1. **'but'** 2. **'however'** 3. **'on the other hand'** 4. **'nevertheless'** 5. **'while'** -clauses also sometimes introduce Contrast.	**Perdana Menteri dan Menteri Kewangan [Dato' Seri Anwar bin Ibrahim]:** It must go down to the level that is considered acceptable as announced *Ia mesti turun sehingga ke paras yang dianggap boleh diterima seperti yang diumumkan* **Perdana Menteri dan Menteri Kewangan [Dato' Seri Anwar bin Ibrahim]:** but can not be too sudden *tetapi tidak boleh terlalu mendadak*
6. Correction	B corrects A.	**Tuan Afnan Hamimi bin Taib Azamudden [Alor Setar]:** At that time about when discussing

		compensation rights claims *Ketika itu tentang— apabila berbincang tentang tuntutan hak pampasan.* **Tuan Afnan Hamimi bin Taib Azamudden [Alor Setar]:** I'm sorry, the demand for pamper and also the Penang water payment. *Maaf saya, tuntutan panjakan dan juga bayaran air Pulau Pinang.*
7. Comment	B provides an opinion or evaluation of the content associated with A. <u>Important Cues:</u> 1. **Speaker-oriented adverbs**, such as the supplemental uses of "luckily", "amazingly", etc 2. **utterance modifiers** such "frankly", "confidentially", etc. 3. **'Sorry', 'Ooh', 'bah', etc.** 4. **Emoticons** also indicate Comments.	**Timbalan Yang di-Pertua [Puan Alice Lau Kiong Yieng]:** The Honorable Kangar stood up first, sorry. *Yang Berhormat kangar berdiri dahulu, sorry.* **Tuan Zakri bin Hassan [Kangar]:** I'm sorry. *Minta maaf.*
8. Conditional	Logical Operation: if… then…, where A is a hypothesis while B is a consequence of the hypothesis. <u>Important Cues:</u> 1. **'If… then…'**	**Puan Yeoh Tseow Suan:** If we can give tax incentives through training *Kalau kita boleh bagi insentif cukai melalui latihan* **Puan Yeoh Tseow Suan:** I believe… *saya percaya…*
9. Continuation	• Similar to Narration, except there is no sequence of actions. • Continuation often holds between two EDUS when they both elaborate or provide background to the same segment.	**Datuk Seri Haji Ahmad bin Haji Maslan [Pontian]**: Overall, the country's inflation rate in 2022 recorded 3.3 percent and is expected to continue to be under control in 2023. *Keseluruhannya, kadar inflasi negara pada tahun 2022 merekodkan 3.3 peratus* **Datuk Seri Haji Ahmad bin Haji Maslan [Pontian]**: and is expected to continue to be

		under control in 2023. *dan dijangka akan terus terkawal pada tahun 2023.*
10. Elaboration	B provides more information about the eventuality introduced in A. <u>Important Cues:</u> 1. **'for instance'** ● Instant noodles are delicious, ● for example Maggi is delicious 2. **explicit listing of sub-events (first, second, etc.)** ● I think instant noodle is bad for health ● First, it has a lot of MSG ● Second, it contains a lot of preservative	**Timbalan Menteri Kewangan [Datuk Seri Haji Ahmad bin Haji Maslan]:** Of course I also find it strange *Tentunya saya juga merasa pelik* **Timbalan Menteri Kewangan [Datuk Seri Haji Ahmad bin Haji Maslan]:** For example, Yang Berhormat Selayang has given an interesting proposal *Sebagai contoh, Yang Berhormat Selayang telah memberikan satu cadangan yang menarik*
11. Explanation	When B explains why, or gives the cause of, what happened in A. <u>Important Cues:</u> 1. **'because'** 2. **'since'**	**Tuan Jimmy Puah Wee Tse [Tebrau]:** This is very strange *Ini amat pelik sekali* **Tuan Jimmy Puah Wee Tse [Tebrau]:** because if we look at the opposition… *sebab kalau kita tengok dalam pembangkang,*
12. Narration	Main eventualities of the EDUs A and B occur in sequence.	**Tuan Jamaluddin bin Yahya [Pasir Salak]:** During my 23 years of sitting, coming back from teaching in Sarawak *Selama saya 23 tahun duduk, balik daripada mengajar di Sarawak* **Tuan Jamaluddin bin Yahya [Pasir Salak]:** and then teaching in 2000 *dan kemudian mengajar tahun 2000*
13. Parallel	Same structural requirements as Contrast, but instead requires A and B to share a common theme.	**Tuan Lee Chean Chung [Petaling Jaya]:** Now in 2000, it has already used, adopted the accrued accounting system.

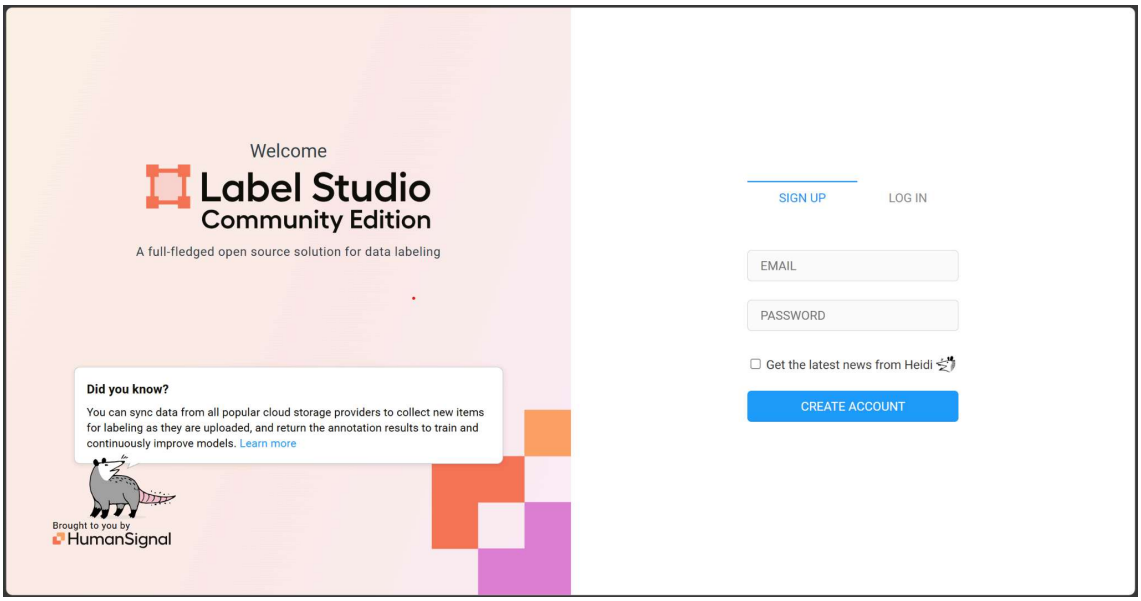
	Important Cues: 1. **'too'** 2. **'also'**	*Sekarang pada tahun 2000, telah pun menggunakan, mengguna pakai sistem accrued accounting.* **Tuan Lee Chean Chung [Petaling Jaya]:** Also, don't forget Canada in 2002, has already adopted accrued accounting, with permission. *Juga, tidak lupa Canada pada tahun 2002, telah pun mengguna pakai accrued accounting, dengan izin.*
14. Q-Elab (Question Elaboration)	Follow-up question intended to get more information in order to answer the first question. Important Cue: 1. **Question mark (?)**	**Dato' Siti Zailah binti Mohd Yusoff [Rantau Panjang]:** May I ask for some clarification please, Your Honor? *Minta penjelasan sedikit, boleh Yang Berhormat?* **Datuk Seri Haji Ahmad bin Haji Maslan:** Is it about EPF? *Tentang KWSP kah?*
15. Question-Answer Pair	A is the question and B is the answer Important Cue: 1. **Question mark (?)**	**Tuan Yang di-Pertua:** Which standing order is that? *Standing order mana itu?* **Datuk Che Mohamad Zulkifly bin Jusoh [Besut]:** Standing Order 23(1)(b). *Standing Order 23(1)(b).*
16. Result	Connects a cause to its effect, i.e., the main eventuality of the first argument is understood to cause the eventuality given by the second. Important Cues: 1. **'so'**	**Tuan Yang di-Pertua:** I have looked at this question and examined and have made a decision that this question does not contradict what Beluran said earlier. *Saya telah melihat soalan ini dan meneliti dan telah membuat keputusan bahawa soalan ini tidak bercanggah dengan apa yang dikatakan oleh Beluran tadi.* **Tuan Yang di-Pertua:** So, I will continue with

		the question. *Jadi, saya akan teruskan dengan soalan tersebut.*
[BLANK]	The EDU segmentation model isn't perfect, sometimes the model will segment the sentence into the illogical segments. To address this problem, we need to connect mis-segmented EDUs. Make a relation, but leaves it blank for the relation type (ie not any of the 16 relation types). It should be noted that **only adjacent segments** shall be connected with this blank relation.	**Datuk Awang bin Hashim [Pendang]:** Meeting Rule 36 *Peraturan Mesyuarat 36* **Datuk Awang bin Hashim [Pendang]:** (6). *(6).* * In this example, the "(6)" should be attached to the "Rule 36", making it "Rule 36(6)". Thus we add a blank relation to connect them.
Interruption	Interruptions connects to previous EDU when there no relevant relation can be found connecting the EDU to other EDUs.	

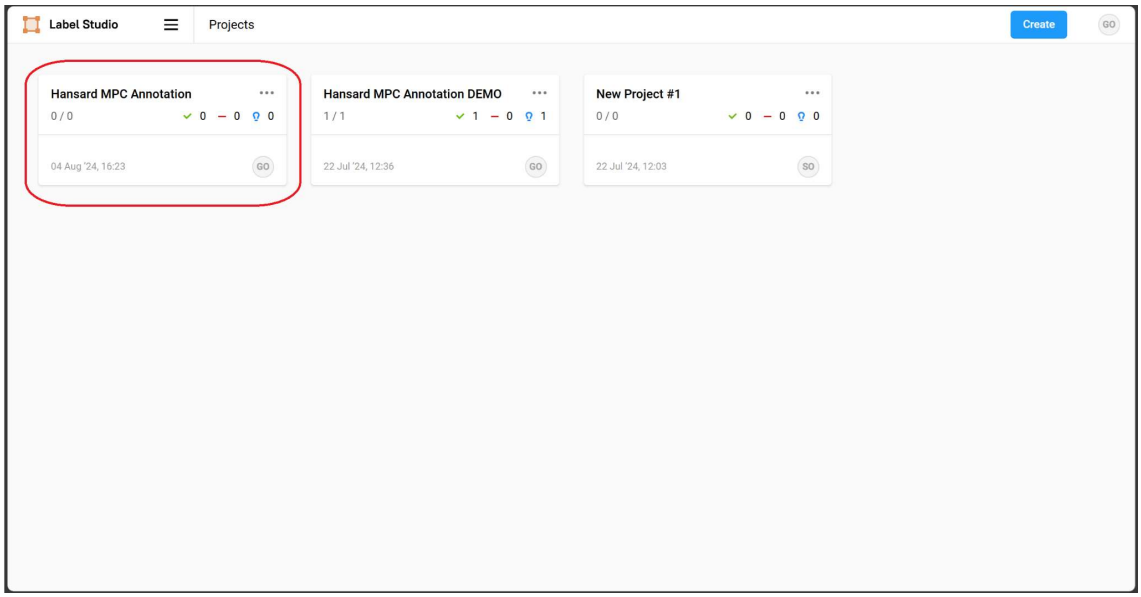
Annotation Platform

Initial setup

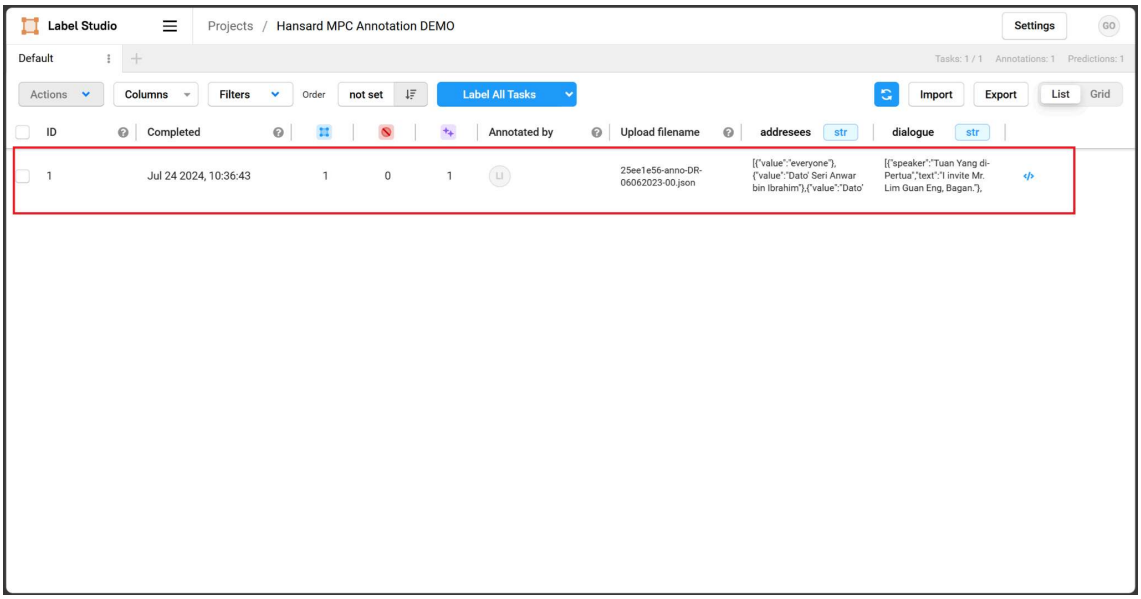
1. Go to https://REDACTED in your preferred browser.
2. Create an account with your preferred username and password. Your username and password will be stored on the website.



3. Select the project named **Hansard MPC Annotation**.

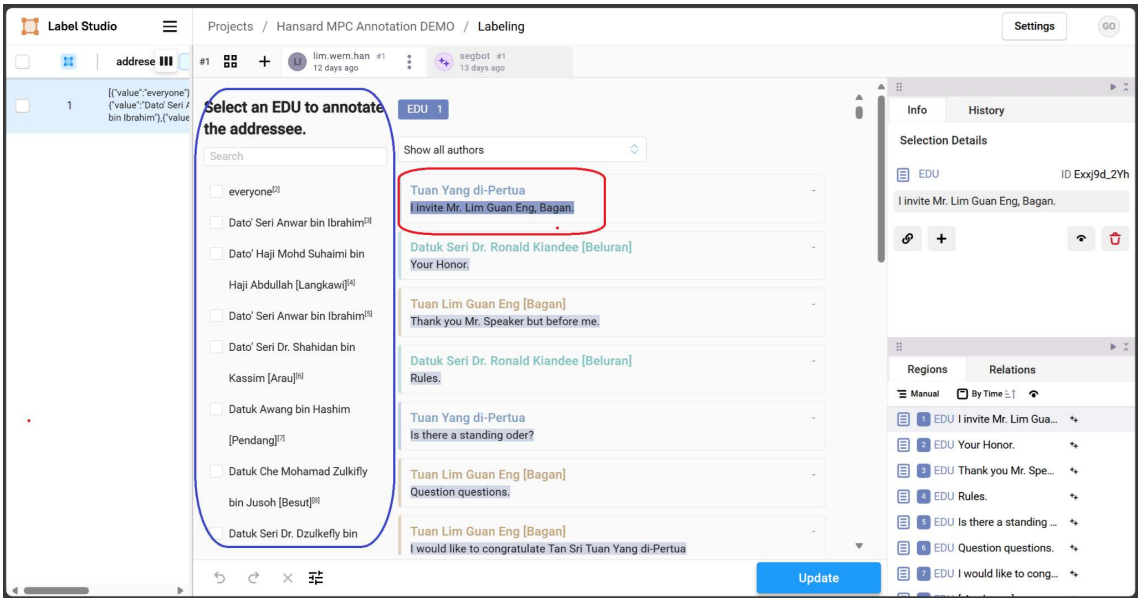


4. Select a document to start annotating.



Annotating addressees

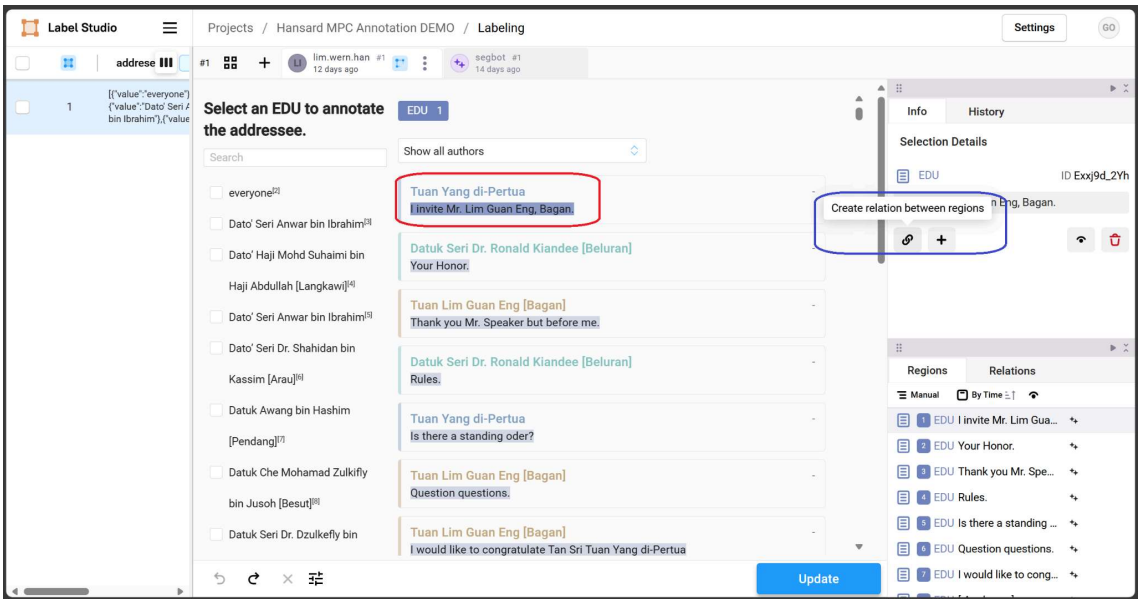
1. Select an EDU from the conversation. (as seen in red).
2. Choose the addressee(s) for the selected EDU from the column on the left (in blue). You can choose one or many addressees. If you think it does not address a specific person, choose “everyone”. You can use the search bar to search for the addresses.



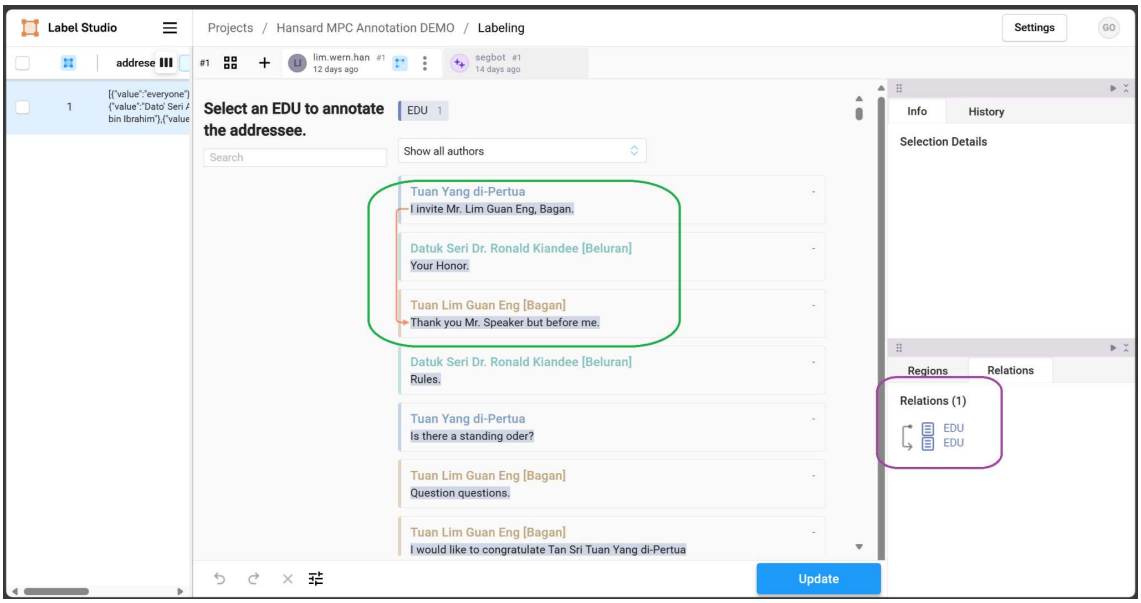
Annotating rhetorical relations

1. Select an EDU from the conversation. (as seen in red).

2. Click on the 🔗 button (as seen in blue).



3. Select another EDU where you want to create a relation with the first selected EDU (see green). You will see the relation created in the Relations tab (see purple).



4. You can toggle the direction of the arrow by pressing on the relation symbol (see orange). Add a label (rhetorical relations) to the relation (see maroon). The changes

are reflected on the conversation (as seen in **black**).

